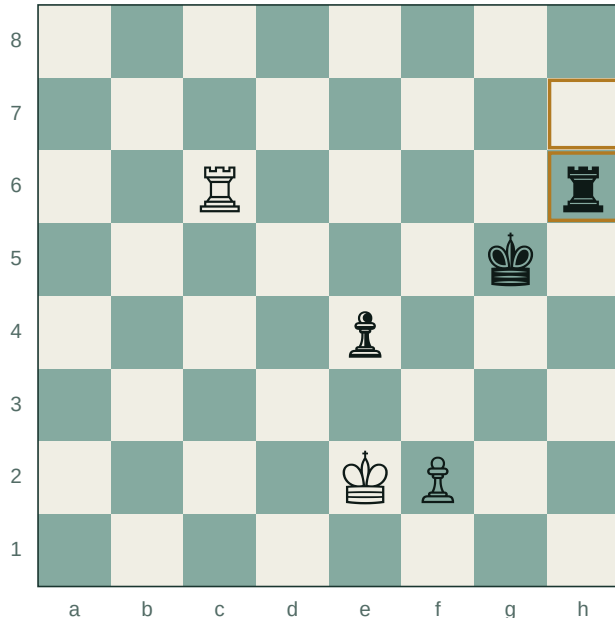


Active defensive resources: White, move 52

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 51...Rxh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52. Rxh6 Kxh6 53. Ke3 Kg5 54. Kxe4 Kf6 55. Kf4

52.Rxh6 The rook captures the rook on h6. Recorded reply: **52...Kxh6**.

53.Ke3 The king moves from e2 to e3. Recorded reply: **53...Kg5**.

54.Kxe4 The king captures the pawn on e4. Recorded reply: **54...Kf6**.

55.Kf4 The king moves from e4 to f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 0 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.